

# Detailed ESG Report - Antwerp (2025)

## Executive Summary

Antwerp presents a mixed ESG profile in its residential real estate market. While parts of the city have seen extensive renovation, a large portion of the housing stock remains old and energy-inefficient. Antwerp benefits from a dynamic real estate market, a growing number of sustainable renovation projects, and a proactive local government. Still, significant challenges remain to meet EU and Flanders 2050 targets.

Key facts:

- Approx. 48% of homes built before 1970
- EPC class A properties account for less than 10%
- Natural gas is the dominant heating source (~70%)
- CO2 emissions average 19 kg/m2/year
- Goal: all homes to reach EPC label A or B by 2050

## Environmental Performance (EPC & CO2 Emissions)

Energy performance in Antwerp varies greatly by district:

- EPC Class Distribution (2025 est.):

- A: 9%
- B: 18%
- C: 25%
- D: 24%
- E-G: 24%

- Heating Systems:

- Natural Gas: ~70%
- Oil/Other: 12%
- Electric Heating: 10%
- Heat Pumps: <6%

- CO2 Emissions:

Average of 19 kg CO2/m2/year, with pre-1960 homes emitting >30 kg CO2/m2/year

- Insulation:

Roof and wall insulation significantly improved in newer developments; retrofitting of older homes is ongoing

## Social Indicators

- Building Age:

48% of properties built before 1970; 22% after 2000  
Historic districts (Zurenborg, Berchem) require careful energy retrofitting

- Population & Density:

Antwerp city: 530,000+ residents, 2,500/km2 density  
Higher turnover of tenants and frequent rental updates

- Energy Poverty:

15-18% of residents at risk, especially in Borgerhout and Antwerpen-Noord

- Public Outreach:

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City campaigns promote energy audits and provide advisors to assist low-income households

### Governance & Legal Framework

- Flemish Energy Policy:  
EPC mandatory since 2008  
Minimum EPC requirements for rental units (Label D minimum since 2023)
- Long-term Targets:  
All homes must reach EPC A or B by 2050
- Subsidies (My Renovation Premium):  
Roof insulation: up to EUR 4,125  
Heat pumps: up to EUR 3,000  
High-efficiency glazing: EUR 16-48/m<sup>2</sup>
- Additional Tax Incentives:  
6% VAT for energy-efficient renovations on homes older than 10 years

### Renovation Scenarios & Financial ROI

- Roof Insulation:  
Cost: EUR 4,000-5,500  
Subsidy: EUR 25-30/m<sup>2</sup>  
ROI: 5-6 years
- Heat Pumps:  
Cost: EUR 11,000-14,000  
Grant: up to EUR 3,000  
ROI: 9-13 years
- Glazing Replacement:  
Value uplift: +4 to 6% for full triple-glazing
- Solar Panels:  
Stable demand; payback in 6-8 years  
Net-metering phased out, but smart tariffs introduced

### Strategic ESG Outlook

- Risk Profile:  
EPC E-F-G buildings face potential restrictions in rental market starting 2028  
Lower-quality stock could lose liquidity
- Opportunities:  
Strategic renovations can lift property value by 10-15%  
Rapid sales for EPC A/B properties, especially in southern and eastern districts
- Market Dynamics:  
Increased investor appetite for retrofitting multi-unit dwellings  
Pressure from EU taxonomy and ESG scoring pushes toward upgrades